

- HAZARDOUS REGION -

THE BELL'S TIDE

Nothing stays the same for a long time here. Wave of fresh water comes every night and floods everything except tree tops and highest towers. With a new day the water declines and disappears as quickly as it came, leaving only a few small ponds, washed up debris, algae and now revealed tunnels to explore.

Unwary wanderer might get caught by the tide in the middle of setting a camp. If they are lucky, they could lose only some of their gear and get washed up on a mossy island wobbling in the current - one of the many strange organisms living here.

Unlike you, most of the fauna and flora here adapted to the everchanging environment of this region. Some critters hide in the mud during the day and swim through long tree roots after the water rises. Others prefer the safety of ponds or make a home in tree crowns.

Not every wanderer is fond of rapidly changing water level, mud and washed up algae but where some see an obstacle others see opportunity: among debris lie lost treasures and ebb reveals secret tunnels potentially leading to relics if one has enough courage and a good timing.

SUGGESTED REGION TRACK: FIVE LOCATIONS

CHANGING TIDES

Water starts rising every bell with the fifth tick, reaches maximum level during the sixth and starts decreasing next bell on the first tick.

If unprepared wanderers are not on greatly elevated place (bridge, staircase, tower, garden and scenic fragment or narrative decision) or flowing island, every wanderer makes one of these rolls:

- + Roll to save their or others stuff. Triumph: save 6 oddments, conflict: save 3 oddments, disaster: save 1 oddment, critical triumph or conflict: save one more oddment, critical disaster: save 0 oddments.
- + Roll to not lose a sense of direction. Same as the previous roll but with fragments.
- + Roll to avoid harm. Triumph: 0 marks, conflict: 1 mark, disaster: 2 marks, critical triumph or conflict: protect 1 other wanderer from harm, critical disaster: +1 mark.
- + Morale roll to not fall into despair. Triumph: gain 0 despair and make 2 other rolls, conflict: gain 0 despair and make 1 other roll, disaster: gain 1 despair.

Treat all rolls that the wanderer didn't roll as disasters. If wanderers are camping during the fifth tick and are caught by the tide they don't finish the current task and cut for speed on the rolls above.

Tip: If wanderers don't know of the tide beforehand, give subtle hints to what is coming and reward especially good observations and rolls by revealing more information.

FLOWING ISLANDS

Some small, some big, some dragged by the current, some attached to the bottom with chains or roots they most commonly consist of moss, stone, wood or are some type of giant animal or superorganism. During the day they may appear as normal hills of greenery but at night when they flow up they might be one of the only places where you can rest your head. When rolling for detail (while exploring a new location or gaining a new fragment) make a luck roll: on 5 or 6 location made with this fragment contains at least one flowing island.

FINDERS KEEPERS

When rolling triumph to find material oddment, wanderer may instead choose to find a 1-track gear aspect marked after use. On critical triumph the aspect is 2-track.

ENCOUNTERS AND EVENTS

Treasure hunters, willing to help, trade or maybe trying to find the thing you came here for before you do.

Stealthy **mud critters** who don't like being stepped on.

Spirits and demons themed around change, cycle, polar opposites etc.

Relic vault that starts flooding after you overstay your welcome.

PLOT HOOKS

After a series of bad dice rolls your party gets flushed by a flood, breaking a bone or two. Objective: Survive. (change region track to 3 locations)

What causes the change of water level? Demon/spirit/two demons/two spirits/spirit and demon/servitors/mother nature?

A spirit sends you to find a precious item their warden lost when they were surprised by the rising tide.

A spirit or demon wants to dry or permanently flood this part of the ruins. Will wanderers complete the quest or protect the unique ecosystem?

The waves are gaining in power endangering adjacent region and shrine of a great spirit. Find out what is going on before it's too late.

Invent surfing and do sick stunts!

INSPIRATION FOR THE GUIDE

estuaries, mangrove forests, riparian forests, old sewer systems, Rain World